

Ann Wordsworth, Critical Theory, Faculty Contingency and the University in Ruins

Cite as: Martin Paul Eve, "Ann Wordsworth, Critical Theory, Faculty Contingency and the University in Ruins", *eve.gd: Martin Paul Eve*, June 04, 2014, <https://doi.org/10.59348/vn3fk-f4m11>.

Bill readings was in the process of making final revisions to this book when he died in the crash of American Eagle flight 4184 on October 31, 1994. [...] To insist on talk as a part of the very fabric of this book is perhaps a step toward acknowledging the singularity of a voice, a place, and a time which would not exist **apart from** the University

- Diane Elam, 'Foreword' in Readings, Bill. 1996. The University in Ruins. Cambridge, Mass: Harvard University Press. p. vii. My emphasis.

*I have forborne to name the individuals who have influenced this book [...]. I will, however, take the risk of mentioning by name the person who first made me aware that the University could be a place to think: Ann Wordsworth. She taught me about something that Oxford called "Critical Theory" and she did so on a **short-term contract**, teaching in a **hut** in the garden of one of the **brick mansions** of North Oxford. I dedicate this book to her.*

-- Readings, Bill. 1996. The University in Ruins. Cambridge, Mass: Harvard University Press. p. x. My emphasis.

Ann taught in a long wooden shed attached to a house in Crick Road, an environment that seemed steeped in radical thought.

-- Jackie Hall, [Obituary](#)

What better place than **here**, what better time than now?